

Sprint 6 Reflection

During this sprint, my primary focus was attempting to implement Firebase Data Connect as the backend for our app's filtering system. This required a deep dive into the structure of our existing codebase, reviewing nearly all of the files we had already created, and drafting new files necessary for Data Connect integration. I spent a significant amount of time trying to understand how Data Connect could replace our Firestore-based logic and how it would interact with the rest of our system. Ultimately, after evaluating the complexity of our app and the limited time left in the project, I made the decision, after discussing it with my team, to not move forward with integrating Data Connect. Instead, we agreed that staying with Firestore was the most realistic and stable option for the project at this stage.

The biggest challenge I faced was the sheer difficulty of integrating Data Connect so late in the development cycle. Our app already relied heavily on Firestore and Cloud Storage, and replacing major backend logic near sprint 4 or 5 would have essentially required us to rewrite large portions of the project from scratch. The combination of learning a new technology, adapting our entire data model, and ensuring compatibility across multiple screens proved too overwhelming within our current timeline. Once I recognized this, I communicated the issues to the team, and we aligned on reverting back to Firestore.

Through this process, I gained a much deeper appreciation for Firestore's ability to handle structured, filterable data effectively. Firestore's use of documents and collections, combined with its intuitive and powerful querying API, allowed me to implement the filtering features we needed without major architectural changes. I also learned that while newer tools like Data Connect offer exciting possibilities, they require proper planning from the start of a project to be used effectively.

One area I could have improved on was maintaining productivity during Thanksgiving break. I underestimated how busy I would be and ended up with more catch-up work afterward. I want to acknowledge and applaud my teammate who continued pushing progress during the break. Moving forward, I hope to better manage my time and communicate potential scheduling challenges earlier.